

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Angela puts her best foot forward. She has been making plans for the future.



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know how to write a cover letter for a job application?
- What should you include?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about jobs and work.
- I can write a cover letter.
- I can write about things I have done or have been doing.





Let's Explore!

Angela spots a job opportunity in the local newspaper for an **entry-level*** journalist position. She needs to write an engaging cover letter for her job application. Can she **put her best foot forward****?

* An "entry-level" job is the first job that a new trainee or graduate takes upon completion of a training.

** To "put your best foot forward" means to impress, to shine in a situation.

Instructions: Read the text aloud.

January 11th, 2015
163 Indigo Way
Cambridge, Massachusetts, 34939

Jeremy Acton
Human Resources Manager
The Sommerville Gazette
P.O. Box 403
Sommerville, Massachusetts, 34920
Dear Mr. Acton,

I am writing to apply for the entry-level journalist position in the news department at *The Sommerville Gazette*.

I have been attending Western Weston College as a journalism student since last year and have been looking for an opportunity to develop my journalism skills in a fast-paced, dynamic environment. As a native of Sommerville, I would enjoy gaining this experience at the Gazette. I have always wanted to stay in the area where I grew up.

I have previously worked as an event coordinator and liaison officer at the Cambridge Community Center. This position provided the opportunity for me to enhance my written communication skills and interact with different community groups. The job also required a strong work ethic and attention to detail. I found the deadlines and responsibilities associated with this position both challenging and rewarding. Furthermore, I have always maintained strong ties with the community and in particular, the businesses in the Sommerville/Cambridge area. My interest in current affairs and related experience makes me ideally suited to this job.

Thank you very much for your time and consideration. If I can provide you with any additional information, please feel free to contact me at (726) 545-8923. I will look forward to hearing from you in the near future.

Sincerely,
Angela Weston





Let's Practice!

Time to practice talking about jobs and work. Have you been paying attention?

Instructions: Match the two parts of the sentences, from Column A to Column B.

COLUMN A

1. I am writing to apply for the entry-level journalist
2. This position provided the opportunity
3. I also interacted
4. My interest in current affairs and related
5. Thank you very much
6. The job also required a strong work

COLUMN B

- a. experience makes me ideally suited to this job.
- b. position in the news department at *The Sommerville Gazette*.
- c. ethic and attention to detail.
- d. with a number of community groups.
- e. for me to enhance my written communication skills.
- f. for your time and consideration.



Let's Practice!

Angela talks about her past experiences and current ambitions*.

*"Ambitions" are particular goals or aims.

Instructions: Read the definitions. Write the words. Find the words in the word search.

1. I have been _____ for an opportunity to develop my journalism skills.
2. I have always _____ strong ties with the community.
3. I have previously _____ as an event coordinator and liaison officer.
4. I have been _____ Weston College as a journalism student since last year.
5. I have always _____ to stay in the area where I grew up.





Extension Activity

A friend needs some help assisting someone with writing a cover letter. Can you help them?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 12 line dialogue between you and a friend.
- Your friend asks you questions about what to include in a cover letter.
- Tell your friend what to include and what to avoid.
- Describe the structure of a cover letter.
- Include the Present Perfect Continuous tense and Present Perfect tense like *I have worked ...*
- Read the dialogue aloud with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I write a dialogue about writing a cover letter.

☐ ☐

I use the Present Perfect Continuous tense and Present Perfect tense to explain events.

☐ ☐

I explain what to include and not include in a cover letter.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- dynamic** (adjective): always active or changing
e.g. I would like to develop my journalism skills in a fast-paced, dynamic environment.
- to enhance** (verb): to increase or improve
e.g. This position provided the opportunity for me to enhance my written communication skills.
- tie** (noun): a connection
e.g. I have always maintained strong ties with the community.
- suited** (adjective): right for, or appropriate for
e.g. My interest in current affairs and related experience makes me ideally suited to this job.
- consideration** (noun): careful thought; the act of thinking carefully about something you will make a decision about
e.g. Thank you very much for your time and consideration.
- to interact** (verb): to talk or do things with other people
e.g. I interacted with a number of community groups.
- work ethic** (noun): a strong belief in the importance and value of work
e.g. The job required a strong work ethic.





Learning Points

Present perfect continuous vs. Present perfect

You use these tenses to express that an action that began in the past is still going on or has just finished.

You usually use the *Present Perfect tense* to express that an action is completed or to emphasize the result.

Forms:

Regular verbs: form of *have* + base form of verb + *-ed*

Example: I have worked at the bakery for six years.

Irregular verbs: form of *have* + past participle of irregular verbs

Example: I have written a number of books in the last two years.

You can use the *Present Perfect Continuous* tense to emphasize the duration or continuity of an action.

Form:

Form of *have* + *been* + base form of verb + *-ing*

Example: We have been working for two hours!

Examples:

- *I have been attending Weston College as a journalism student since last year.*
- *I have previously worked as an event coordinator and liaison officer at the Cambridge Community Center.*
- *I have always maintained strong ties with the community.*





Learning Points

Writing a Cover Letter

A cover letter is a single-page letter that should be included in a job application. It needs to be engaging and show the employer that you have the skills, education and experience to do the job.

There is certain information that you should include in a cover letter.

1. Put your name and contact details at the top of your cover letter. Ensure that your e-mail address sounds professional to create the right impression.

Also, include the name, position and contact details of the person you are writing to under your contact details. It is important to determine the name of person and not simply use, "To Whom It May Concern".

2. Explain which job you are applying for. For example: *I am writing to apply for the advertised Entry-Level Journalist position.*

3. Your cover letter should include a summary of your education, skills and experience that match the job description. It needs to respond to all the essential requirements of the position as well as any additional information that may be desirable.

4. After listing your education, skills and experience, you need to explain why you are suited to the job. For example: *My previous work as a liaison officer and interest in current affairs makes me ideally suited for this job.*

5. Your cover letter should finish by suggesting that the hiring manager review your résumé as well as contact you about an interview. For example: *I have attached a copy of my résumé for your consideration. I look forward to hearing from you about this application.*

